
GCC term sheets look different this quarter. Debt is showing up before equity.

Founders aren't raising equity first anymore. They're done paying the tax of defending a valuation nobody in the room believes.

**Debt first means no mark to defend,
ownership stays intact through the trough,
and the cap table stays clean for the round
that actually needs pricing.**

The lender underwrites cash flow. Not a narrative.

The capital that shows up first as a lender gets the best seat later: information rights, relationship, first call.

Founders chasing the highest valuation are optimizing for a headline. Which capital is actually built for this corridor?

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